

THE GARAMUT



A MESSAGE SENDER

Ps Barry's Reflections on: **PRAYER, PROCLAMATION and PERSONAL PROGRESS**

Bethel Global Missions
No.2. 10th of March 2025



OUR STUDY

IS CENTRED AROUND AN EVENT THAT TOOK PLACE IN THE LIFE OF JESUS IN WHICH HE WAS INVOLVED WITH SOME PARENTS BRINGING THEIR CHILDREN TO BE BLESSED BY HIM AND THE DISCIPLES' REACTION. THIS IS FOUND IN THE GOSPELS OF MATTHEW AND LUKE.

Luke 18:15-16

15 One day some parents brought their little children to Jesus *so he could touch and bless them*. But when the disciples saw this, *they SCOLDED the parents for BOTHERING him*.

16 Then *Jesus CALLED for the children* and said to the disciples, "*LET the children come to me. DON'T STOP them!* For the Kingdom of God belongs to those who are like these children. NLT

Luke 18:15-17

15 Now they were also bringing [even] babies to Him that He might touch them, and when the disciples noticed it, *they reproved them*.

16 But Jesus called them [*the parents*] to Him, saying, Allow the little children to come to Me, and *do not hinder them*, for to such [as these] belongs the kingdom of God.

17 Truly I say to you, whoever does not accept and receive and welcome the kingdom of God like a little child [does] shall not in any way enter it [at all]. AMP

OUR MESSAGE

- BEING CAREFUL NOT TO PREDETERMINE WHAT GOD'S RESPONSE MIGHT BE IN A PARTICULAR SITUATION.
- NOT SEEKING TO GOVERN OR MANAGE THE OUTCOME OF AN EVENT INVOLVING OTHERS BY ASSUMING AHEAD OF TIME HOW JESUS OR GOD MIGHT RESPOND.
- NOT TO UNDERTAKE CERTAIN ACTIONS WHICH MAY BE GOOD IN THEIR OWN RIGHT BUT THEY ARE ENDEAVOURING TO ANTICIPATE WHAT JESUS' OR GOD'S ANSWER OR ACTIONS MIGHT BE.

MAN'S WEAKNESS

Sadly, Man's weakness is that he still wants to control or manage the outcome of events of his own life without necessarily asking for God's help.

IN THIS STORY the disciples wrongly **presumed** that Jesus would not be interested in entertaining matters concerning children in the light of the weightier matters that were currently before him.

IN SIMPLE TERMS THE DISCIPLES PRESUMED THAT IT WAS RIGHT TO TRY AND PROTECT JESUS FROM UNNECESSARY DISTRACTIONS AND THAT JESUS SHOULD NOT BE '**BOTHERED**' BY THESE PARENTS WHO WERE BRINGING THEIR CHILDREN TO BE BLESSED.

- To be bothered' means to trouble, to inconvenience.

HOWEVER, THESE DISCIPLES WRONGLY ASSUMED WHAT THE RESPONSE OF JESUS WOULD BE.

THAT IS WHAT OUR MESSAGE IS ABOUT TODAY

IT IS NOT ASSUMING OR PRESUMING HOW JESUS OR GOD MIGHT ACT OR RESPOND IN ANY GIVEN SITUATION AFFECTING US OR OTHERS.

HOW OFTEN DO WE DO BEHAVE IN A SIMILAR WAY AS THE DISCIPLES WHERE WE PRESUME THAT CHRIST RESPOND TO OUR NEED OR EVENT THAT WE ARE FACING IN A CERTAIN WAY.

- Where we think that God is too busy with more important matters than to attend to ours.
- OR we assume that our needs are small compared with what other people's needs are and that theirs would take precedence over ours.

A personal story

Some years ago, I had just been appointed as Pastor of an existing church and one day while visiting the congregation members I came to the house of a dear old lady who was so faithful and a dearly loved member of the church. I asked her how she was, and she replied that she had a very bad headache, so I offered to pray for her healing.

She replied 'thank you but there is no need to pray because I thought God is so busy with other important things and I did not want to **bother** him, so I took some headache medicine. I was so surprised to hear this statement, but I realised that this dear lady sincerely and genuinely thought this way. That God is too busy, and my needs **are small compared with what other things that he has to do.**

But since that day I have wondered how many of God's people think like that lady.

IN OUR STUDY TODAY WE SEE HOW THE DISCIPLES THOUGHT BY SHOWING SUCH HARSH ACTION OF **SCOLDING, REBUKING AND STOPPING** THE PARENTS FROM BRINGING THEIR CHILDREN TO JESUS.

EVEN THOUGH THEY HAD GOOD INTENTIONS IN TRYING TO PROTECT JESUS FROM UNNECESSARY AND UNIMPORTANT THINGS IT REVEALED WHAT THEY THOUGHT ABOUT THE PLACE OR POSITION OF CHILDREN IN THE MINISTRY OF THE KINGDOM.

IN AFFECT THEY WERE TRYING TO GOVERN OR CONTROL THE OUTCOME OF THIS EVENT BY ASSUMING THAT JESUS WOULD NOT BE WELCOMING OF THESE CHILDREN BEING BROUGHT TO HIM.

HOW WRONG THE DISCIPLES WERE TO PRESUME, ASSUME SUCH THINGS.

OUR MESSAGE FROM THIS PASSAGE IS

1. **DON'T TRY AND MANAGE JESUS OR PREDICT HOW HE OR GOD IS GOING TO RESPOND OR ACT**
2. **GOD FREELY AND WITHOUT RESTRICTON DOES ALL THINGS AFTER THE COUNSEL OF HIS OWN WILL.**
Ephesians 1:11 In whom also we have obtained an inheritance, being predesignated according to the purpose of him who worketh all things after the counsel of his own will: Webster
3. **AND WE AS BELIEVERS MUST ALLOW JESUS AND GOD TO RESPOND AS THEY FEEL FIT AND WE SHOULD REFRAIN FROM TRYING TO PREDETERMINE HOW THEY MIGHT OR SHOULD ACT.**
4. **WE MUST NOT TRY TO GOVERN BY PREDICTING OR PRESUMING WHAT THE OUTCOME WILL BE OF THOSE EVENTS AND CIRCUMSTANCES IN WHICH WE HAVE ALREADY ASK JESUS / GOD TO HELP.**
5. **BUT UNWITTINGLY** HOW MUCH DO WE SEEK TO GOVERN GOD'S RESPONSES BY THE WAY WE THINK OR FROM SOME PAST EXPERIENCE.

AMEN - Pastor Barry